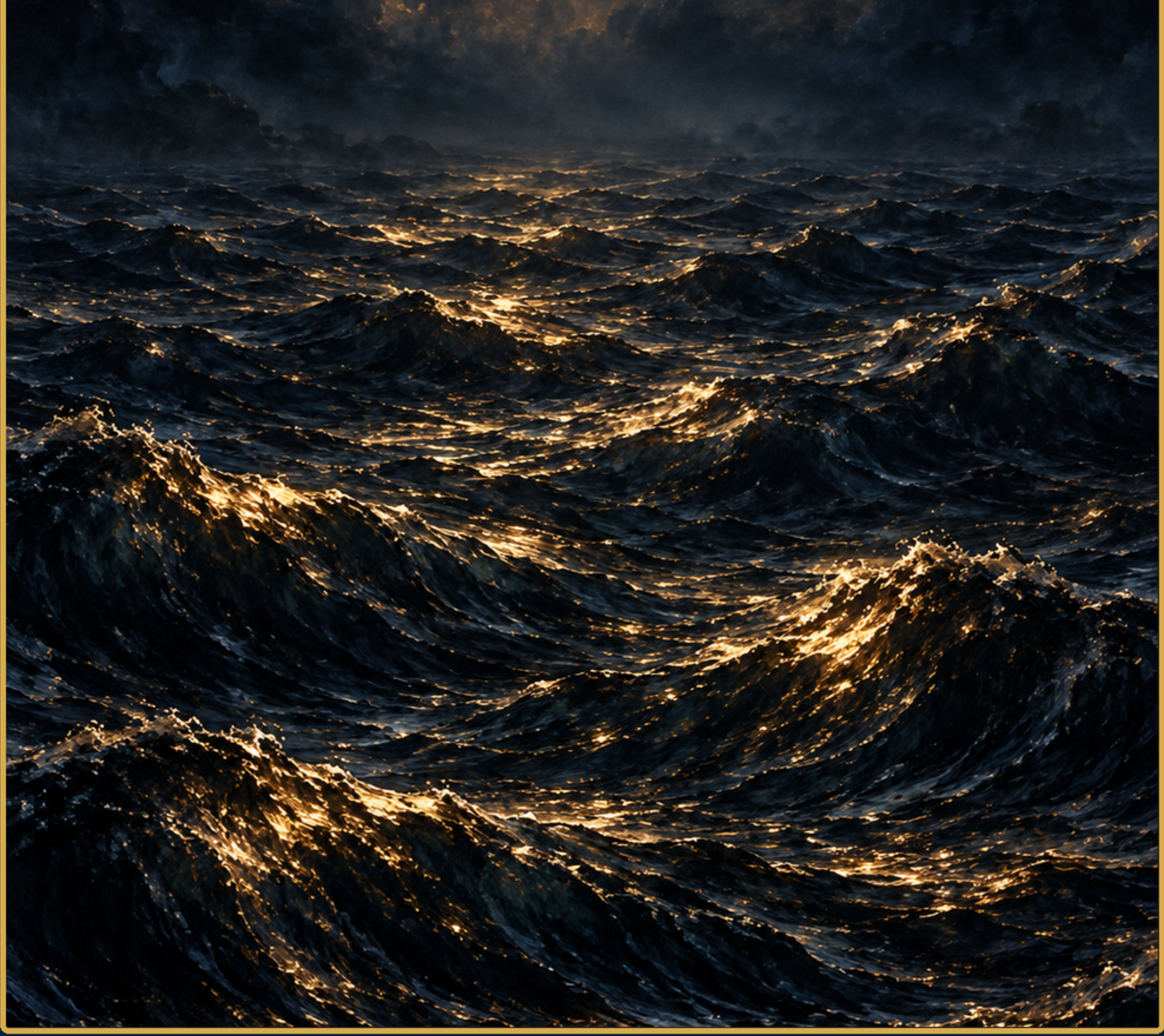
BEYOND REMEMBERED SEASONS

1 Then his story moved beyond kingdoms, roads and remembered seasons, to the dissolution of a world.

INTERNAL PREVIEW — NOT APPROVED FOR PUBLICATION

WATER WITHOUT SHORE

1 Water stretched through the vastness. No shore divided one direction from another. There was no field to cross, no mountain path to climb, no city lamp to mark a home. The flood of dissolution held the scene in a silence deeper than ordinary night.



INTERNAL PREVIEW — NOT APPROVED FOR PUBLICATION

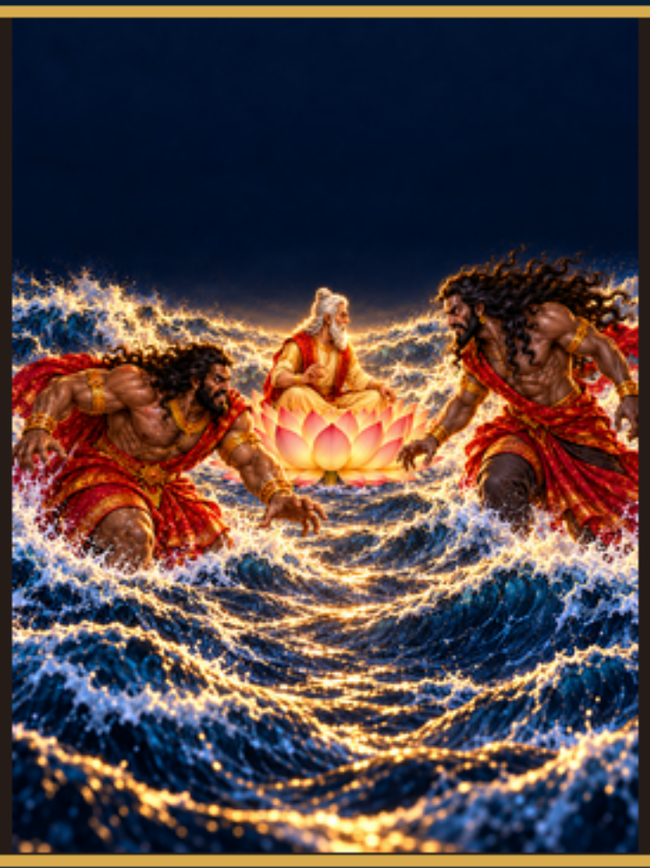
DANGER AND ANSWER TOGETHER

1 Brahma looked from the approaching figures to Vishnu. The preserver still rested upon Shesha, held in the depth of Yoganidra. No call from the lotus had yet broken that sleep.

Madhu and Kaitabha came nearer.

2 There was nowhere for Brahma to flee. Around the lotus lay the same endless flood. Below it slept the one who could face the threat. Yet the sleep upon Vishnu was itself divine power, not an ordinary weariness that Brahma could simply shake away.

The danger and the answer stood almost together: the threatening Asuras upon the waters, Vishnu beneath the lotus, and the power of sleep holding him still.



INTERNAL PREVIEW — NOT APPROVED FOR PUBLICATION

A PLACE OF INVOCATION

1 Brahma did not address the sleepers with a hurried shout. He turned his praise toward Yoganidra herself.

The silence at the end of the world became a place of invocation.

Brahma gathered his attention and praised the Goddess who held Vishnu in sleep.

INTERNAL PREVIEW — NOT APPROVED FOR PUBLICATION

BRAHMA'S HYMN

1 Brahma gathered his attention and praised the Goddess who held Vishnu in sleep.

You are the sacred utterance by which offerings are made. You are the power by which creation arises, by which it is preserved, and by which it is drawn again into dissolution. You are knowledge, and you are the great illusion that can veil knowledge. You are nature, nourishment and peace. You are also power armed against danger.

INTERNAL PREVIEW — NOT APPROVED FOR PUBLICATION

THE CONFRONTATION CLOSES

1 Vishnu rose to meet Madhu and Kaitabha.

No army marched into the waters. No ranks gathered behind him. Vishnu met the two Asuras with his arms, and the combat closed around them.

The two Asuras turned from the lotus to face him.

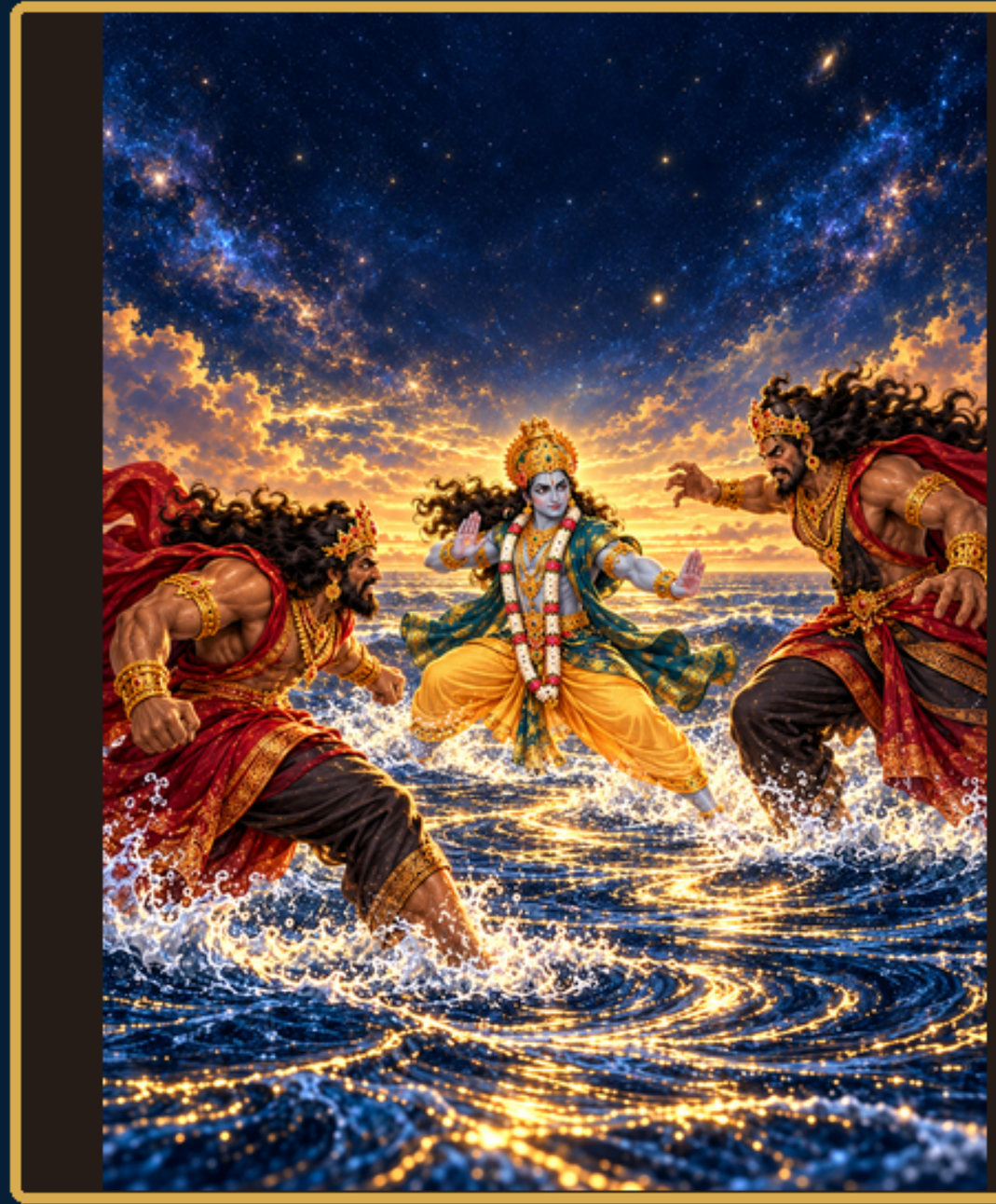
2 Brahma’s danger had not vanished; it had become a confrontation. Yoganidra had answered the invocation by withdrawing, appearing before Brahma, and opening the way for Vishnu to wake.

Now the long struggle began.

STRENGTH AGAINST STRENGTH

1 Vishnu grappled with Madhu and Kaitabha upon the cosmic waters.

A hold was made and broken. One Asura drove forward; Vishnu checked him. The other closed from the side; Vishnu turned to meet him. Again they joined, separated and returned.



FIVE THOUSAND YEARS

1 Years passed, yet the struggle did not end.

Hundreds became thousands.

For five thousand years, Vishnu fought the two Asuras with his arms.

INTERNAL PREVIEW — NOT APPROVED FOR PUBLICATION

THE REVERSAL

1 The story’s measure of time is immense, but its problem is easy to understand: strength met strength, and still the danger remained. Whenever one attacker was forced back, the other pressed in. Whenever both were driven away, they returned to the struggle.

Then Yoganidra’s power brought the reversal Brahma had requested.

Madhu and Kaitabha became deluded. Intoxicated with their own strength, they no longer saw the contest clearly. They had fought Vishnu for five thousand years, and pride made them speak as if the advantage were theirs to give.

INTERNAL PREVIEW — NOT APPROVED FOR PUBLICATION

THE UNUSUAL OFFER

1 Madhu drew back.

2 Kaitabha stood beside him.

Ask a boon of us.

Yes. Choose what we shall give.

3 After an age of combat, the strangest moment in the battle was not another blow. It was the offer made by the two who had come as enemies.

They had become the boon-givers.

Vishnu answered them.

INTERNAL PREVIEW — NOT APPROVED FOR PUBLICATION

VISHNU NAMES THE BOON

Then let the boon be this. Let both of you be overcome by me.

1 The words changed the shape of the contest.

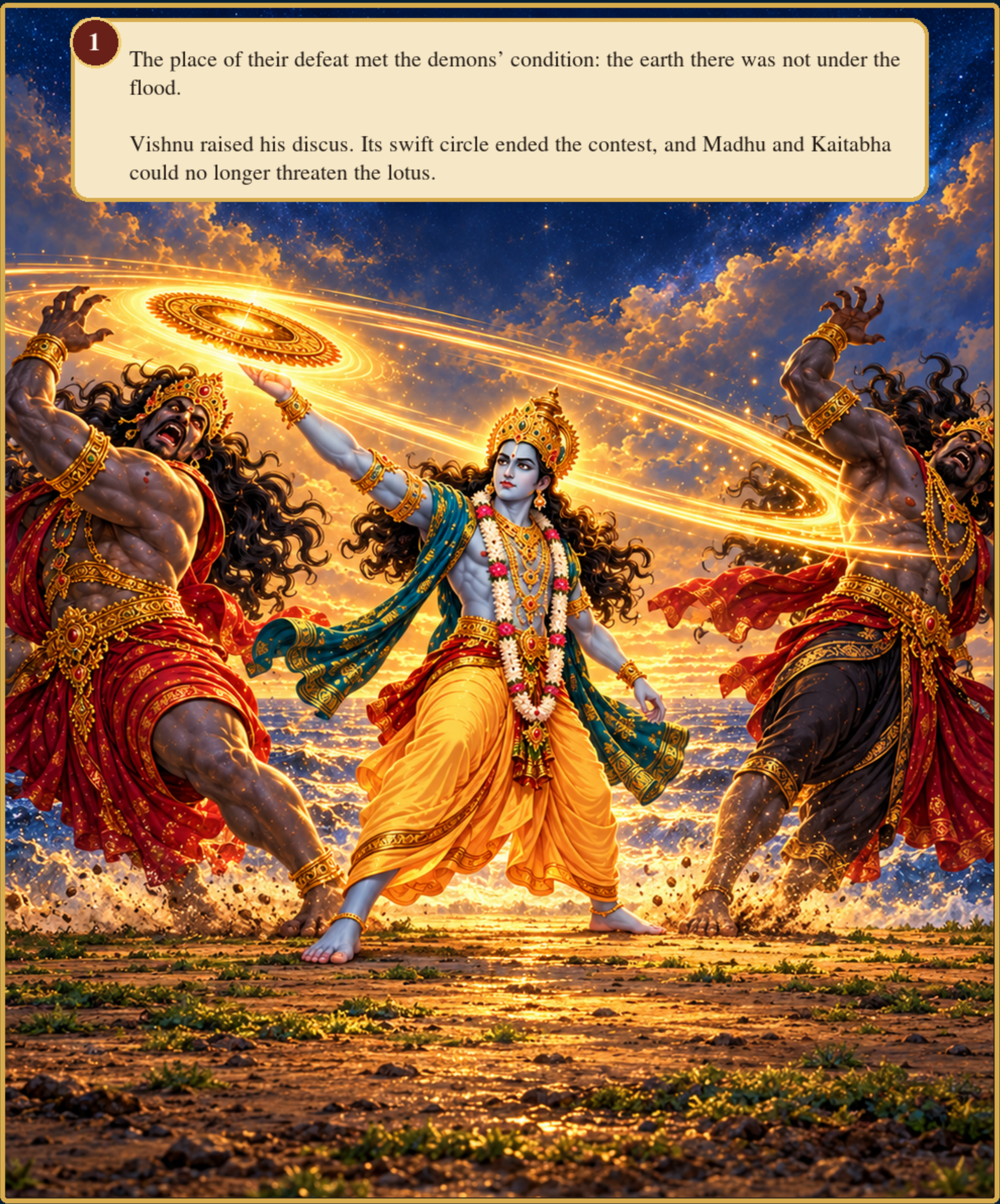
Madhu and Kaitabha had offered the boon jointly. Vishnu had not asked them for land, treasure or long life. He had asked for the one outcome their pride had not expected to grant: their own defeat at his hands.

WHERE THE EARTH WAS NOT FLOODED

1

The place of their defeat met the demons' condition: the earth there was not under the flood.

Vishnu raised his discus. Its swift circle ended the contest, and Madhu and Kaitabha could no longer threaten the lotus.



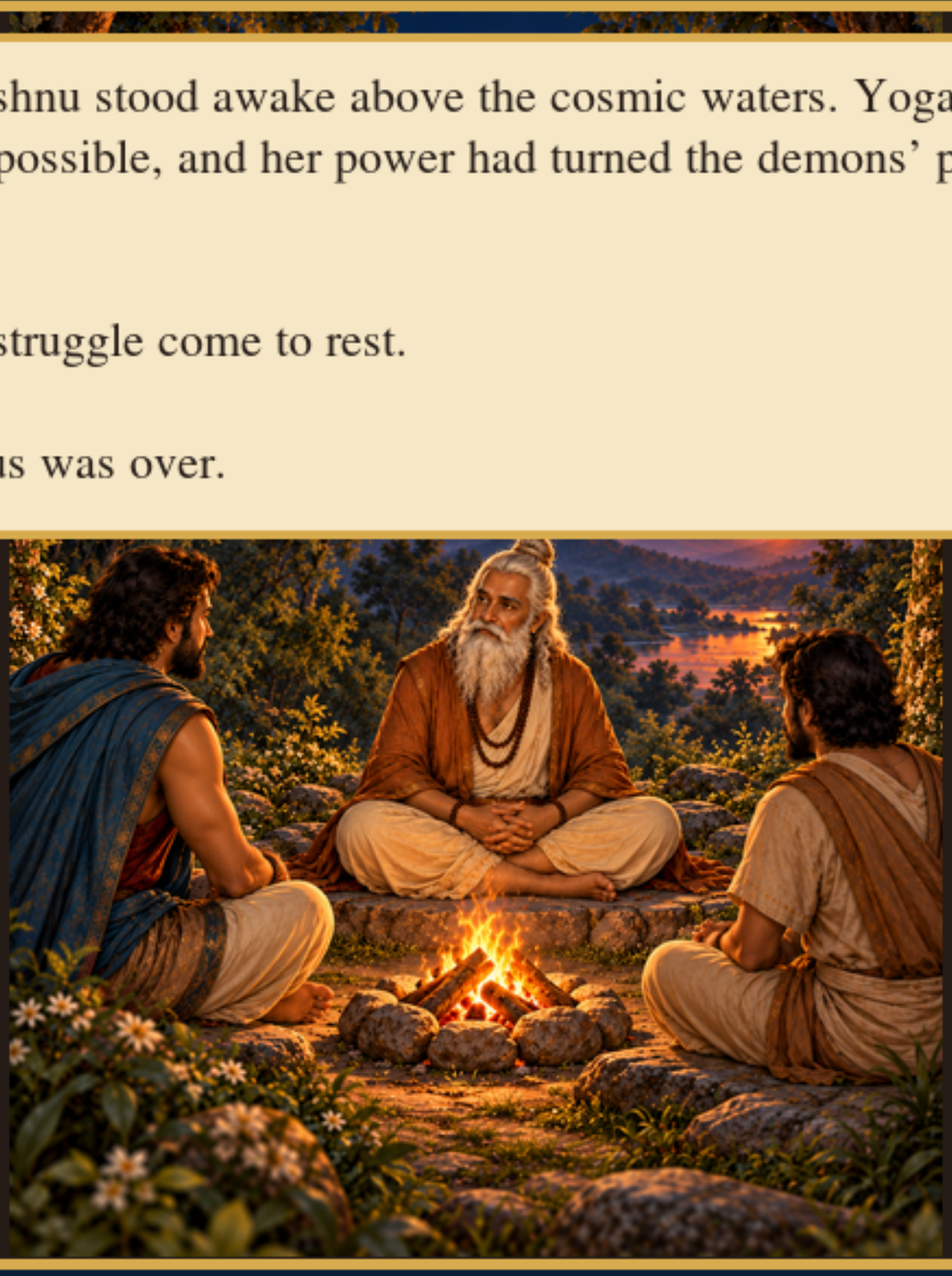
INTERNAL PREVIEW — NOT APPROVED FOR PUBLICATION

THE DANGER ENDS

1 Brahma was safe. Vishnu stood awake above the cosmic waters. Yoganidra’s withdrawal had made his awakening possible, and her power had turned the demons’ pride toward the boon that ended them.

Sage Medhas let the struggle come to rest.

The danger at the lotus was over.



SOURCE AND ADAPTATION NOTE

This private editorial draft is fresh original English prose based only on the locked paraphrases and locators for Devi Mahatmya 1 in dm-event-004 through dm-event-007. Brahma's cosmic and theological descriptions are presented as his attributed hymn-praise, not as independent project certification. All dialogue is non-verbatim adaptation. The five-thousand-year combat, joint boon offer by Madhu and Kaitabha, Vishnu's requested boon, the unflooded-earth condition and the discus defeat remain in source order. No demon genealogy, earlier ascetic or invulnerability boon, outside boon-giver, divine motive or sacred quotation has been added. Because the bounded English and Sanskrit witnesses leave the final bodily locus unresolved, the manuscript states only that the water condition is met and omits any thigh, lap, buttocks or other precise locus. The DM08 manuscript was consulted only as a literary-quality benchmark and was neither copied nor treated as evidence. This clearance permits only a private manuscript draft; illustration, PDF production, publication, public sharing and distribution remain blocked.

EDITORIAL REFLECTION — A THOUGHT FOR FAMILIES

This is a modern editorial reflection, not a quotation from scripture.

Sleep, sustained strength and the boon condition each change the story in a different way: Yoganidra’s withdrawal makes awakening possible, Vishnu endures the long struggle, and the demons’ own condition opens the way to its end.

For family conversation: When a problem will not yield to force, what condition might be holding it in place? What can change when that condition is understood?

INTERNAL PREVIEW — NOT APPROVED FOR PUBLICATION